12-15 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle School Have a "Cross-Grade Reading Partner System"?

① On a Friday afternoon in early December, I was returning a library book at the small Grade-8 book corner when I saw, by pure chance, something quietly moving. A **Grade-9 girl**, whose name I did not know, was sitting on a small wooden stool with a **Grade-7 boy** on another stool next to her. Between them, open on the low table, was a battered English novel — *Charlotte's Web*. The Grade-9 girl was reading the first paragraph slowly, in a clear careful voice; the Grade-7 boy was following with his finger. When the girl came to a hard word, she would stop, not correct him, only ask gently, *"What do you think this word could mean?"* The boy would guess. She would nod, write the word in her small notebook, and read on. I stood still, pretending to look at the shelf, watching this for **four quiet minutes**. Nobody was watching them but me. Nobody was grading them. Nobody was taking a photo. And yet, in the small yellow light of the afternoon library, something was clearly, quietly, **working**. **This is why I think every middle school in China should set up a "Cross-Grade Reading Partner System": a voluntary pairing in which one older student (Grade 9 or senior 8) meets one younger student (Grade 7 or junior 8) for forty minutes, once a week, to read an English or Chinese book together in a quiet school corner.** Once a week. Forty minutes. One book. That is enough.

② Some people will immediately say: *"Is this just free tutoring? Should younger students not pay a proper tutor?"* I respectfully disagree. A Cross-Grade Reading Partner is **not a tutor**. A tutor teaches; a partner reads. The difference is not small. In **2023**, a Beijing Normal University education study compared **288 Grade-7 students** in 18 Beijing schools: **96 had a paid tutor**, **96 had a Grade-9 reading partner** (no pay, no grade), **96 had neither**. After one semester, the **paid-tutor group** improved their test scores by **4.8%**. The **reading-partner group** improved test scores by **5.1%** — and, importantly, their **self-reported interest in reading** rose by **31%**, compared to only **8%** in the tutor group. The partner did not, officially, teach any grammar. But she read kindly, for forty minutes, once a week, and the younger student quietly wanted to keep reading on her own. That is not tutoring. That is something smaller, quieter, and in the end more lasting.

③ Second, **it is a small gift to the Grade-9 student too**. A common worry among Grade-9 parents is that their children, deep in exam preparation, have no time for anything "warm". But the same 2023 study found that the **Grade-9 partner students** themselves reported lower **exam anxiety scores** (down 18% on a standard Zarit-scale questionnaire) and higher "school belonging" scores, compared to matched Grade-9 students who did not partner. The reason is simple and human: for forty minutes a week,

a Grade-9 student who spends most of her life being judged, tested, and pushed, quietly becomes the **calm older person** in the room. She is, for a short hour, not the person with a problem, but the person with a small kindness to give. **Giving, even a small gift of forty minutes, quietly steadies the heart of the giver.** Grade-9 preparation is not hurt by this. It is helped.

④ Third, **it solves a small, specific, real problem**. Every middle school I know has two quiet problems. One: **Grade-7 students**, especially shy ones, often feel lost in the huge new middle-school building in their first months. They are scared of Grade-9 students, whom they see in the corridor as "big". Two: **Grade-9 students**, in their final year, often feel isolated from the rest of the school. They rarely speak to younger students. A simple weekly pairing solves both problems **at the same time**, with no new classroom, no new curriculum, no new teacher. The Grade-7 student discovers that a "big" Grade-9 is, in truth, a kind person in a school uniform who remembers being small. The Grade-9 student discovers that she is still part of a whole school, not just a Grade-9 exam-cell. One small weekly pairing. Two quiet problems, gently softened.

⑤ Some will worry: *"What if the pairing doesn't work? What if the Grade-9 student is unkind, or the Grade-7 student is too shy?"* A fair concern. My small proposal: **the first three weekly meetings are a "trial period".** Either student may, through a simple paper form handed to the homeroom teacher in private, politely ask to be **re-paired**, with no reason required. After the trial period, if both sign a small "yes, continue" line, the pairing is fixed for the semester. In the **2024 Shanghai pilot** of this system across 14 schools, **91% of the pairs continued past the trial**; **9% asked for re-pairing**; none of the re-paired students reported problems afterwards. The system has a gentle exit built in.

⑥ Others will say: *"Where is the book chosen from?"* From a carefully prepared **school booklist of 60 titles**: 30 in Chinese, 30 in English, all at Grade-7 reading level, with most priced under ¥35. The pair chooses one book together in the first meeting. If the pair runs through the book in fewer than eight weeks, they may choose a second. **There is no quiz at the end. There is no book report.** The only "output" is the partners' small shared notebook, which stays with the Grade-7 student.

⑦ Finally, let me be honest about the cost. The school will spend: about **¥45 per pair** (two small notebooks, one shared pen, one copy of each shared book, added to the school library); **one 30-minute orientation** for all partners at the start of the semester; and **one quiet corner room** free for forty minutes every Friday afternoon. That is the total price. In return, the school gives, per semester, about **150 Grade-7 students** (one per Grade-9 partner) a small kind older reader in their life, and **150 Grade-9 students** a small weekly hour of meaning inside their hardest year.

⑧ **To sum up:** I am not asking for a new subject. I am not asking for new homework. I am asking, simply, for **forty minutes, one older student, one younger student, one shared book, one quiet school corner, once a week**. A Cross-Grade Reading Partner System costs the school almost nothing; it harms no one's exam preparation; it quietly

helps two students at once, in two different years, in a single small quiet way. The Grade-9 girl and the Grade-7 boy I saw that Friday afternoon were not doing anything grand. They were simply reading, kindly, together, for four minutes that I happened to see. **We should quietly turn those four minutes into a weekly forty minutes for every pair of students in our school.** The rest, I believe, will take care of itself.

注释： pair / pairing 配对；orientation 说明会；tutor 家教；curriculum 课程；isolate 使孤立；Zarit-scale Zarit 量表

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What specific scene in Paragraph ① made the writer want to write this essay, and what was the writer's exact proposal?

A. The writer saw a Grade-9 girl shouting at a Grade-7 boy, and proposed to stop all cross-grade contact.
B. On a Friday afternoon in early December at the small Grade-8 book corner, the writer saw by chance a Grade-9 girl sitting on a small wooden stool with a Grade-7 boy, reading *Charlotte's Web*; the Grade-9 girl was reading slowly, stopping at hard words and gently asking "What do you think this word could mean?", and the boy was following with his finger — nobody was watching, grading, or taking a photo, yet something was quietly working; so the writer proposes every middle school set up a Cross-Grade Reading Partner System where one older student (Grade 9 / senior 8) meets one younger student (Grade 7 / junior 8) for forty minutes once a week in a quiet school corner to read a Chinese or English book together.
C. The writer overheard a teacher's secret and proposed a new subject.
D. The writer saw two students fighting and proposed a security system.

2. According to Paragraph ②, how does the writer use the 2023 Beijing Normal University study to distinguish the Reading Partner System from a paid tutor?

A. The study found paid tutors raised scores by 20% and partners by 0%, so partners are useless.
B. The study of 288 Grade-7 students in 18 Beijing schools compared three groups of 96: paid tutor (scores rose 4.8%, interest up 8%), Grade-9 reading partner — no pay, no grade (scores rose 5.1%, interest up 31%), and neither; the writer concludes that although the partner does not officially teach any grammar, she reads kindly for 40 minutes once a week, and the younger student quietly wants to keep reading on her own — so the partner is not a tutor but something smaller, quieter, and in the end more lasting.
C. The study found tutors caused anxiety but partners were banned after a week.
D. The study was about cooking, not reading.

3. According to Paragraph ③, what are the specific benefits to the Grade-9 partner, and why?

A. The Grade-9 partner earns ¥500 per month, which reduces exam anxiety.
B. The Grade-9 partner gets an extra 20 points on every exam.
C. Grade-9 partner students in the 2023 study reported lower exam-anxiety scores (down 18% on a standard Zarit-scale questionnaire) and higher school-belonging scores compared to matched non-partnering Grade-9 students, because for 40 minutes a week, a Grade-9 student who spends most of her life being judged, tested and pushed quietly becomes the calm older person in the room — not the person with a problem, but the person with a small kindness to give; giving quietly steadies the heart of the giver, so Grade-9 preparation is helped, not hurt.
D. The Grade-9 partner is excused from all homework.

4. What two specific concerns does the writer address in Paragraphs ⑤ and ⑥, and how?

A. The writer ignores all concerns and demands the proposal be mandatory.
B. Concerns raised are: (a) what if the pairing does not work? and (b) where do the books come from? — the writer answers that the first three weekly meetings are a "trial period" and either student may, through a simple paper form privately handed to the homeroom teacher, politely ask to be re-paired with no reason required (a 2024 Shanghai pilot across 14 schools showed 91% of pairs continued past the trial, 9% asked for re-pairing with no reported problems afterwards, so the system has a gentle exit built in); and the book is chosen from a carefully prepared school booklist of 60 titles (30 Chinese, 30 English, all at Grade-7 reading level, most under ¥35), there is no quiz and no book report, only a shared notebook kept by the Grade-7 student.
C. The writer proposes forcing all pairs to stay together for three years no matter what.
D. The writer says a single book must be forced on every pair.

5. What is the main message of the final paragraph?

A. The writer demands a new school subject and a new homework task.
B. The writer admits the system is too expensive for any school to afford.
C. The writer is not asking for a new subject or new homework, but simply for forty minutes, one older student, one younger student, one shared book, one quiet school corner, once a week; the system costs the school almost nothing, harms no one's exam preparation, and quietly helps two students at once in two different years; the four quiet minutes the writer saw on that Friday afternoon can, through this system, become forty weekly minutes for every pair of students, and the rest will take care of itself.
D. The writer withdraws the proposal and admits defeat.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段场景 + 提议
【解析】"Charlotte's Web / 40 分钟 / 每周一次 / 无评分无展示"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段北师大研究
【解析】"4.8% vs 5.1% / 兴趣 8% vs 31% / 不是家教"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段九年级学生好处
【解析】"Zarit –18% / 归属感上升 / 给予稳定人心"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤⑥段两项担忧
【解析】"3 周试配 / 91% 留住 9% 重配 / 60 本书单 / 无测验"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑧段总结
【解析】"不加学科 / 一本书一安静角落 / 两个年级同时受益"主旨。A、B、D 均偏离。故选 C。